

The Fifty Prompts

From Teaching in an AI World (AI with Confidence, Book 1) by Kevin D. Graham

(A note on what these are: starting points, not scripts. None of these templates is magic, and none is meant to be used verbatim — they're built on the six-part anatomy from Chapter 5 (Purpose, Context, Source material, Constraints, Output format, Quality check) and designed to be revised. The first thing to do with any prompt here is make it yours: swap in your grade, your standard, your constraints, and then talk back to whatever the AI returns. The conversation after the prompt is where the value is.)

⚠ On every page: *No student-identifying information ever goes into a prompt — no names, no diagnoses, no family details. All output passes the Five-Step Review (Accuracy → Alignment → Appropriateness → Accessibility → Final teacher judgment) before students see it. *Italic notes under prompts flag the most common failure to watch for.**

Planning (1-2, 11-18)

1. “Create a [length] lesson on [topic] for [grade] students who already know [prior knowledge]. Align to the standard below: [paste]. Include [components]. Mark anything requiring teacher verification.”
2. “Here’s my lesson plan: [paste]. Suggest three ways to add student discussion, and one way this lesson could confuse a struggling reader.”
11. “Create a [length]-week unit outline on [topic] for [grade] [subject], aligned to the standards below: [paste]. For each week: the focus, one core activity, one formative check. Mark anything requiring teacher verification.” *Watch for: optimistic pacing — AI units always run long in real classrooms.*
12. “Give me five different opening hooks for a lesson on [topic] for [grade] students: one question, one demonstration, one story, one challenge, one surprising fact. Flag anything that needs fact-checking.” *Watch for: the “surprising fact” — verify it before you build a lesson on it.*
13. “Create a substitute-ready plan for [length] on [topic]: step-by-step directions a non-expert can follow, no technology required, a materials list, and an early-finisher task.” *Watch for: materials you don’t actually have in the room.*
14. “Convert this lesson into [number] stations of [minutes] each: [paste lesson]. Include a direction card for each station written at a [grade]-grade reading level.”
15. “List six real-world applications of [concept] relevant to teenagers’ lives, each with a one-sentence discussion starter.” *Watch for: dated examples — AI’s idea of “current” may be years old.*
16. “Students just finished [prior topic] and are starting [new topic]. Write a ten-minute bridge activity that connects them and surfaces the misconceptions most likely to carry over.”

17. “Restructure this lesson to fit [minutes] without cutting the guided practice: [paste]. Tell me what you cut and why.” *The “tell me why” line is the point — it makes the AI show its reasoning for your review.*

18. “Create an introduction routine for these terms: [list]. For each: a student-friendly definition, an example, a non-example, and a visual or gesture cue.” *Watch for: definitions that are almost right — check each against your content.*

Differentiation & Support (3–4, 19–26)

3. “Rewrite this passage at three reading levels — [levels] — keeping all key concepts intact: [paste].”

4. “Suggest five ways to make this activity accessible for a student who [general need — no names, no diagnoses]: [paste activity].”

19. “Create three versions of this task — supported, on-level, and extension — keeping the same learning goal: [paste task]. List what changed in each version.”

20. “Write discussion sentence stems for [topic] at three language-proficiency levels, plus five key vocabulary words with suggested visuals.”

21. “Students will read this passage: [paste]. Create a pre-reading preview: three guiding questions, four vocabulary words with kid-friendly definitions, and one prediction task.”

22. “Rewrite these multi-step directions as numbered, single-action steps with a checkbox for each, at a [grade]-grade reading level: [paste].”

23. “Create a nine-square choice board for demonstrating mastery of [skill/standard], varying the product type — write, draw, build, record, present. Keep every option equal in rigor.” *Watch for: unequal rigor anyway — that’s your judgment call, not the AI’s.*

24. “Design two extension challenges for students who finish [task] early — deeper application of the same concept, not more of the same. No new materials.”

25. “Suggest general supports for a student new to English joining mid-unit on [topic]: visuals, partner structures, what to prioritize first. General strategies only — I will adapt them myself.” *Never include anything identifying the student. Strategy ideas only; the plan is yours.*

26. “Based on these common error patterns from a recent assessment — [describe the patterns, no names] — design a fifteen-minute small-group reteach with one quick check at the end.”

Assessment & Feedback (5–6, 27–34)

5. “Create a rubric for [assignment] with [number] criteria on a [scale] scale. Write the descriptors so a [grade]-grade student can understand exactly what each level looks like.”

6. “Write [number] exit-ticket questions on [topic]: one recall, one application to a new scenario, one ‘explain your thinking.’ Include an answer key with common wrong answers and what each reveals.”

- 27.** “Write [number] questions on [topic] climbing from recall to application to analysis to creation. Label each level. Include an answer key.” *Solve and check every item — AI writes unsolvable problems with total confidence.*
- 28.** “Create [number] multiple-choice questions on [topic] where each wrong answer represents a specific, common misconception. After each question, note which misconception each distractor reveals.” *This one turns your quiz into diagnostic data — verify the misconceptions match what you actually see.*
- 29.** “Generate a bank of twelve reusable feedback comments for [assignment type] aligned to this rubric: [paste] — four naming strengths, four naming growth areas, four suggesting next steps. Student-friendly language.”
- 30.** “Create a student self-assessment checklist for [assignment] from this rubric: [paste], phrased as ‘I can’ statements with an evidence line under each.”
- 31.** “Turn these review topics into a team game for [minutes]: [list]. Include rules, scoring, and twenty questions with answers.” *Verify all twenty answers. A review game that teaches a wrong answer is worse than no review.*
- 32.** “Convert this assignment description into a [number]-criterion rubric with student-language descriptors: [paste]. Flag any criterion the assignment doesn’t actually ask for.” *That last line catches the phantom-criterion problem from Chapter 3 before it reaches students.*
- 33.** “Create a practice set of [number] problems on [skill], ordered easiest to hardest, with one worked example at the top and a full answer key.”
- 34.** “Write five reflection questions students answer after getting back a graded [assessment] — focused on their process and preparation, not the grade.”

Communication & Admin (7–8, 35–40)

- 7.** “Draft a warm, professional email to families about [general topic — never a specific student]. Three short paragraphs, 6th-grade reading level, ending with one clear action step.”
- 8.** “Rewrite this announcement in plain language for families who may be reading in a second language, then provide a Spanish version for a fluent speaker on my campus to review: [paste].”
- 35.** “Draft a monthly class newsletter section covering: [bullets]. Warm, brief, 6th-grade reading level, one action item for families.”
- 36.** “Draft three versions of a short positive note home about a student showing growth in [general area]. I will add the name and specifics in my own email.” *The name never enters the tool — you personalize in your district email, per Chapter 3.*
- 37.** “Write a reminder about [event] in three lengths: two sentences, one paragraph, and a full letter. Plain language throughout.”
- 38.** “Turn these rough notes into a clear summary with decisions, action items, and owners: [paste notes — strip names and sensitive details first].”

39. “Create an outline for a recommendation letter for a student applying to [type of program]: the categories I should cover and the questions I should ask myself. Do not write the letter.” *By design. The outline is machinery; the opinion of the student is yours alone (Chapter 3’s hard floor).*

40. “Rewrite this syllabus section in friendlier plain language without losing any requirements: [paste].” *Re-read against the original — “friendlier” sometimes quietly drops a requirement.*

Student-Facing & AI Literacy (9–10, 41–50)

9. “Explain [concept you teach] the way an expert tutor would to a new teacher — including the two misconceptions students most commonly develop and how to head them off.”

10. “I have [minutes] of planning time and this list: [paste]. Order it by impact on student learning, and tell me which items I could delegate to AI drafting — and which I shouldn’t.”

41. “Create a blank study-guide template for [topic] that students fill in themselves: sections, guiding questions, and a self-quiz frame. Include no answers.” *The blankness is the point — the filling-in is the studying.*

42. *(Student, green-light)* “You are my study partner for [topic]. Quiz me one question at a time, wait for my answer, tell me if I’m right and why, and get gradually harder. Don’t let me change the subject.”

43. *(Student, yellow-light)* “Here is my draft: [paste]. Give feedback on my argument and organization as questions and suggestions only. Do not rewrite any of my sentences.” *Teach students this one explicitly — it’s the difference between a coach and a ghostwriter.*

44. *(Student assignment)* “Write a prompt asking for help understanding [concept]. Then improve it twice using Purpose, Context, Constraints, and Format. Turn in all three versions with a note on what changed and why.”

45. *(Teacher-run, for class critique)* “Generate a one-paragraph summary of [topic] containing three subtle factual errors for my students to find. List the errors separately for me only.” *Chapter 7’s Confident Liar demo, ready-made. Check that the “correct” parts are actually correct too.*

46. “List the claims in this AI-generated paragraph that would need verification, and what kind of source would verify each: [paste].”

47. “Present the two strongest opposing viewpoints on [class-appropriate debatable topic], each in three neutral sentences, with one discussion question.” *Read for hidden lean before class — neutrality is a claim to verify, not assume.*

48. “List ten day-to-day tasks of a [career]. Mark which AI could assist with today and which still need a human, with one reason each.” *Chapter 9’s career conversation as a fifteen-minute activity.*

49. “Explain [concept] three ways: to a ten-year-old, to a new [grade]-grader, and to an adult expert. Keep each under 100 words.”

50. “Here is a prompt I wrote: [paste]. Critique it against this checklist — Purpose, Context, Source material, Constraints, Output format, Quality check — and show me an improved version, explaining each change.” *The library eating its own cooking: the last prompt teaches you to outgrow the other forty-nine.*

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